The History and New Thinking of National Security Discipline Construction

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Abstract: The term "National Security Science" first appeared in the article "Safety Science and Accident Prevention" published in the 12th issue of "China Science and Technology Information" in 1994. The earliest article discussing national security studies from the perspective of discipline construction was "Speaking for National Security—Concept of "National Security Studies"" published in the internal journal "Capital National Security" No. 2 in 1998. "National Security Studies", published by China University of Political Science and Law Press in May 2004, is the first book on national security studies at home and abroad, creating a new discipline of national security studies. On April 9, 2018, the Ministry of Education issued the "Implementation Opinions on Strengthening National Security Education in Universities and Primary Schools", which put forward the clear requirements of "promoting the construction of national security disciplines" and "establishing a first-level discipline of national security studies". However, under the background that General Secretary Xi Jinping proposed the overall national security concept in April 2014, national security studies as a first-level discipline have been difficult to meet the requirements of the overall national security concept. National security disciplines include first-level disciplines such as national security law, national security strategy, military science, police science, intelligence science, diplomacy, and non-traditional security science. Keywords: national security; discipline construction; first-level discipline; discipline categories; higher education

Discipline Construction Process of National Security Studies

In the history of human thought, science, and social science, "national security" is a term and concept that appeared very late, and "national security" is a discipline name that only appeared in the 1990s.

For a long time, the term "national security" has been identified as being first proposed by Lippmann, an American expert on international issues, in 1943. However, we have seen that the American Lippmann is not talking about "national security", but national security. "National security" in Chinese is not equal to national security in English. It can also be translated to refer to state security, and the Russian Государственной Безопасности corresponding to state security clearly appeared in the government agencies of the Soviet Union as early as July 1934. It is the "General Administration of State Security" that evolved from the All-Russian Cheka, which was established in December 1917, and changed its name several times. Later, the "General Administration of State Security" established in 1934 underwent many changes, and finally in March 1954 it became the "National Security Council" with wide-ranging influence, that is, the KGB. The KGB's Russian name Комитет Государственной Безопасности has also been translated into Chinese as "National Security Council", but its English translation is not the same as the English translation of the US National Security Council. The National Security Council is different, it is the Committee of State Security, and the "national security" in it is not national security, but state security. Therefore, in the Chinese system, it is inaccurate to say that the term "national security" was first proposed by Lippmann in 1943. The accurate expression should be that the American Lippmann proposed the term national security in English in 1943.

Not only that, the word "national security" in the Chinese language itself also predates 1943. Through literature search, we found that the term "national security" appeared in Zhang Bi's article "Germany's Abolition of the Locarno Convention and European Political Situation" published in 1936 in the magazine "World Knowledge" founded in Shanghai in 1934.

The term "national security", whether it is Государственной Безопасности, which appeared in Russian in 1934, that is, state security, or "national security", which appeared in Chinese in 1936, and in 1943 in National security in English, they were not a common political and academic term in the 1930s and 1940s. Even after the enactment of the National Security Act of 1947 in the United States, "national security" still did not become a common word in the political and academic fields, and even "security" did not become a common word in the political and academic fields. Throughout the four volumes of Selected Works of Mao Zedong, the word "safety" is used only

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Once, "national security" never came up. At this time, the term "national security studies" did not even exist.

The term "national security" has been used more and more widely in the political field, starting around the end of the Cold War. After the founding of the People's Republic of China, although the Chinese Communist Party and the Chinese government attached great importance to national security issues, they did not use the term "national security" for a long time. The term "national security" was first used in official documents before the establishment of the Ministry of State Security in 1993. At that time, the leaders of the State Council mentioned the establishment of the Ministry of State Security in the government work report. In academic circles, although the term "national security" has been used in a small amount in the 1950s, the scope of use is mainly limited to the evaluation of foreign national security agencies (such as the US National Security Council) and the analysis of international national security issues. However, it is rarely used to analyze China's national security issues, and there is no in-depth study of national security theoretical issues and national security discipline construction at the academic level. It was not until the 1990s that the term "national security" was mentioned more in the academic and political circles, and the corresponding national security research and the term "national security studies" came into existence.

As far as we can see so far, the term "National Security Studies" first appeared in the article "Safety Science and Accident Prevention" published in the 12th issue of "China Science and Technology Information" in 1994. This article starts from the construction of security disciplines, and introduces the term "national security science", and believes that "the discipline of security science can be very broad, such as national security science, social security science, ecological environment safety science, labor safety science, etc." [2] Later, the author of this article, Zhu Yibao, published the article "Prevention of Urban Disaster Reduction—An Unavoidable Major Issue" in the 12th issue of "China Science and Technology Information" in 1996, repeating the above point of view: "There are many aspects of safety science. Disciplinary composition, such as national security, social security, ecological environment security, labor safety, etc." [3] In 1998, Cai Peiyuan and Zhang Caifeng published in "China Higher Education Research" 1998 No. 1 "Humanity The article "Security Needs and Theoretical Research of Defense Science" talks about national security science from the perspective of defense science, and thinks that defense science in a broad sense is "the science that studies the law of the development and change of human security needs and how to realize this need.". "Starting from this definition, it is not difficult for us to infer the concepts of its sub-disciplines. For example, the science of national security is the science that studies the law of development and change of national security needs and how to achieve national security goals by focusing on covert work."[4] The book "Russian Agents" published by Zhang Wei in January 1998 quoted a report from Taiwan's "Central Daily News" that in the courses offered by an intelligence school of the Russian Foreign Intelligence Service, "the subject of national security is still at a low level. formative stage, It is mainly composed of two basic contents: reconnaissance and counter-reconnaissance".[5]

The earliest article discussing national security studies from the perspective of national security discipline construction was published by the author in the internal publication "Capital National Security" Issue No. 2 in 1998, "Speaking for National Security—Concept of "National Security Studies"[6] one article. This article was soon published in the first issue of the "National Security Newsletter" under the title "A Preliminary Study on the Establishment of "National Security Studies"" [7] and then condensed and published in the first issue of 1999. wrote: “The establishment of national security studies has become a theoretical topic with important practical significance.” “From this year, this column will open up a special topic of ‘National Security Theory Discussion’, aiming to prosper academic research and promote theoretical research. research process.”[8]

Since then, some teaching and research personnel of the School of International Relations have published a series of articles specifically discussing the construction of national security disciplines. In October 2002, "Basics of National Security Studies" co-authored by the teaching and research personnel of the School of International Relations was printed and used. As one of the editors-in-chief of "Basics of National Security Studies", the author took "National Security Studies" as an option in 2001 and took the lead in applying for the establishment of high-quality textbooks for higher education in Beijing, and obtained approval and financial support. In April 2003, the author published the article "On the Object, Task and Disciplinary Nature of National Security Studies" in the second issue of "Journal of Shanxi Normal University (Social Science Edition)", pointing out that "National Security Studies is an emerging comprehensive Practical political science. Its research objects include four aspects: national security itself, factors affecting national security, factors endangering national security, national security guarantee system and activities. Its basic task is to comprehensively and systematically study and Discuss the objective state, nature, and laws of national security and its related objects, explore reasonable national security concepts and national security strategies, and serve and guide national security activities." [9] In May 2004, "National Security Studies" edited by the author Publicly published by China University of Political Science and Law.

As the first professional textbook on national security published in China, "National Security" created the new discipline of "National Security". In 2006, it was rated as an excellent textbook for higher education in Beijing, and in 2008 , Won the "Second Prize of Outstanding Achievements in Philosophy and Social Sciences in Beijing" issued by the Beijing Municipal Committee of the Communist Party of China and the Beijing Municipal People's Government. It has had a wide and far-reaching impact on society. In July 2006, the Academic Committee of the School of International Relations reviewed and approved 4 school-level A-level excellent courses, and "National Security" was among them. In the same year, the author applied for the project of teaching reform in Beijing colleges and universities with "Professional Status of National Security Studies and Discussion on Teaching Content and Methods" and was approved. At the beginning of 2009, "Boutique Pass

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The course "National Security Studies" System Construction" was awarded the "2008 Beijing Education and Teaching Achievement (Higher Education) Second Prize". In June 2009, the "National Security Studies" course was awarded the "2009 Beijing Higher Education High-quality courses in schools". In October 2012, the research report on "Professional Status of National Security Studies and Discussion on Teaching Content and Methods" passed the acceptance check.

The 2004 edition of "National Security Studies" was the first national security subject system to be established in China, and the system structure and basic content are innovative and systematic to varying degrees. However, judging from the later situation, there are still some areas that need to be revised and supplemented. . For this reason, the author published the book "Building a Study for National Security—The Exploration Process of National Security Discipline and Research on Some Issues" published in 2014, which explored some new issues in the discipline construction of national security studies and made the theoretical system of national security studies more complete. , also raises the issue of the subject status of the national security discipline.

The Subject Status and Content of National Security Studies

Not long after the concept of "National Security Studies" was proposed, the author decided that National Security Studies is not only the name of a discipline, but also a general term for a category of disciplines. Later, in the article "National Security Science is the Unity of National Security Science and National Security Philosophy", the author mentioned ": As the name of a discipline, 'National Security Science' is one of the 'National Security Sciences' It is a basic and general subject, so it can be more accurately named as 'Principles of National Security Science' or 'Basic Principles of National Security Science'. As the name of a class of disciplines, 'National Security Science' includes many specific national security sciences , such as domestic security, international security, national political security, national military security, national economic security, national security intelligence, national security anti-espionage, national security strategy, national security law, etc. It is more accurate to call it 'national security discipline' or 'national security discipline'."[10] Obviously, the author here has two ideas on the status of national security discipline: One is that national security discipline can be "First-level discipline"; the second is that the national security discipline can become a "discipline category".

In the book "Building Studies for National Security" published in 2014, the author discussed the status of national security disciplines more cautiously. On the one hand, the author believes that "National Security Studies" can be juxtaposed with "Public Security Studies" and become a first-level discipline under the category of law; If you choose, you can transitionally take National Security Studies as a major under the first-level discipline of "Political Science". [11]

However, this cautious view on the status of the national security discipline has been outdated in the overall national security strategy layout of the party and government in my country in recent years. With the establishment of the National Security Council, the introduction of the overall national security concept, the promulgation of the "National Security Strategy Outline" and the continuous advancement of national security legal construction, the issue of national security education and national security discipline construction in our country has also been put on the forefront. In terms of its increasingly important strategic position, the construction of "a first-level discipline of national security studies" is clearly recorded in the documents of the Ministry of Education. The "National Security Law of the People's Republic of China", promulgated and implemented on July 1, 2015, stipulates that "April 15 every year is the National Security Education Day for All People", and also stipulates that "incorporating national security education into the national education system and civil servant education and training system ". On April 15, 2016, the eve of the first National Security Education Day, General Secretary Xi Jinping instructed: "We must take the establishment of the National Security Education Day as an opportunity, and under the guidance of the overall national security concept, fully implement the National Security Law and carry out in-depth National security publicity and education, and effectively enhance the national security awareness of the whole people." On April 14, 2016, the General Office of the Ministry of Education issued a notice requiring teachers and students to generally master national security knowledge, enhance national security awareness, and consciously maintain national security. On April 9, 2018, the Ministry of Education issued the "Implementation Opinions on Strengthening National Security Education in Universities and Primary Schools", pointing out the necessity and importance of carrying out national security education in universities, middle schools and primary schools, and giving national security education to universities, middle schools and primary schools from multiple levels. Safety education has made deployment arrangements, one of which is to "promote the construction of national security disciplines" and "establish a first-level discipline of national security studies".

After the document of the Ministry of Education proposed "the establishment of a first-level discipline of national security studies", some universities held a seminar on the construction of a first-level discipline of national security studies. Scholars put forward some different ideas on how to build a first-level discipline of national security studies. Some scholars agree with the author's previous point of view, and believe that the first-level discipline of national security should be set under the category of "law science", and some scholars believe that the first-level discipline of national security should be set under the category of "management science". It was during this discussion that I thought over and over again based on the basic content and viewpoints of the overall national security concept, and felt more and more that today, when the overall national security concept has been put forward, the study of national security should not be just a first-level discipline, but should be become a discipline.

In my country's current catalog of higher education majors, there is a subject category called "Military Science". If the discipline of national security is established, then this discipline must include military security and broader military issues. This is because, in reality and in essence, the military is an issue of national security, an important means of safeguarding national security, an important content of national security, and an important part of the national security system. with real military

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It belongs to the category of national security, and national security includes military adaptation. In terms of discipline relationship, military science cannot be absent from the national security discipline system, and military science should not be outside the national security discipline system. That is to say, in terms of the logical relationship of disciplines, military science can only be subordinate to national security studies, and national security studies must be placed above military science. To this end, the category of "Military Science" in the current professional catalog can be replaced with "National Security", put "Military Science" as a first-level subject under the category of "National Security", and renamed it "Military Science" ". While downgrading "Military Science" to a first-level discipline and changing its name to "Military Science", it is also necessary to include the first-level discipline of "Public Security Science" that used to be under the category of "Law Science" into the category of "National Security Science", and Renamed to the more general "police science". In addition, "Diplomatics", which is in the first-level discipline of "Political Science", also needs to be included in the category of "National Security" and upgraded to a first-level discipline. This is because, regardless of the military, police, and diplomacy, their main function is to ensure national security, and they are all important forces to ensure national security. In this way, the first-level disciplines under the national security category include not only national security principles, national security management, national security law, and national security strategy as basic theories, but also military science as an important aspect of national security. Science, police science, intelligence, diplomacy, etc., as well as the new non-traditional security studies, frontier studies, etc.

As mentioned above, there are many first-level disciplines under the category of national security science, some of which are relatively mature, such as military science, police science, diplomacy, etc., and some have some preliminary results in recent years, such as national security principles, national security management Studies of national security law, national security strategy, non-traditional security studies, etc., and some need to further establish a relatively complete theoretical system on the basis of previous research results, such as information science, frontier studies, etc. At the same time, under non-traditional security studies, non-traditional security majors such as anti-terrorism studies, national information security management, national ecological security studies, and national cultural security studies can be set up. The reason why national security disciplines have such rich content and so many first-level disciplines and second-level disciplines need to be established is determined by the richness of contemporary national security reality.

National Security Studies is a social science theory with Chinese characteristics pioneered by the School of International Relations. In the construction of the national security discipline system, the School of International Relations has always been at the forefront of the times. After passing the audit of the Ministry of Education in 2017, the School of International Relations has recruited the first batch of graduate students majoring in national security in 2018. In addition, the School of International Relations is also preparing to recruit undergraduates majoring in national security in 2019. When conditions permit, doctoral students majoring in national security will also be recruited. We hope that in the near future

In the future, the subject of national security can be officially included in the catalog of higher education in my country as a subject category, so that more colleges and universities can justifiably recruit students majoring in national security, and also enable graduates majoring in national security to obtain better employment opportunities, and ultimately provide better talent guarantee and knowledge services for my country's national security. Beijing Education

This article is funded by the National Key Research and Development Program "Research and Application of Key Technologies for National Security Risk Management" (Project No.: 2018YFC0806900), and the Key Project of Innovation Team Building of the School of International Relations "Research on the Deepening and Perfection of National Security Principles" (Project No. : 3262018T01) phased research results

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